



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

University, Classes & Academic Life

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 14

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to talk about classes and assignments, understand common university vocabulary, ask professors or classmates for clarification, and discuss deadlines and academic responsibilities.

Learn the academic vocabulary, then practise obligation language with “have to”, “need to”, and “be supposed to”. Finish with the Conversation Lab by discussing a course, a group assignment, and a deadline problem.

Communication goal

Academic English is often about clarifying expectations. Ask what is required, when it is due, how it should be submitted, and how the work will be evaluated.

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A simple sequence: learn the key language, practise the structure, and then use it in a realistic conversation.

01

LEARN

Vocabulary + useful chunks

02

BUILD

Grammar + model dialogue

03

SPEAK

Writing + role-play

Warm-up

1. What subject do you enjoy studying most?
2. Do you prefer lectures, practical classes, or projects?
3. What type of assignment takes you the most time?
4. How do you usually organize deadlines?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English using short sentences. Do not worry about mistakes yet. The goal is to activate the topic before studying the new language.



VOCABULARY 01

Essential vocabulary

Study the meaning and then read each example aloud. Try to connect each word to a real situation from your own life.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
course	disciplina / curso	I am taking five courses this semester.
lecture	aula expositiva	The lecture starts at 8 a.m.
professor	professor	I emailed the professor.
classmate	colega de turma	I am working with two classmates.
assignment	trabalho / atividade	The assignment is due Friday.
deadline	prazo	The deadline was extended.
exam	prova	We have an exam next week.
grade	nota	The final grade includes the project.
syllabus	plano / ementa da disciplina	Check the syllabus for the schedule.
attendance	presença / frequência	Attendance is mandatory.
presentation	apresentação	Our presentation is ten minutes long.
group project	trabalho em grupo	We are doing a group project.
research	pesquisa	The project requires some research.
reference	referência	Add the references at the end.
submit	entregar / enviar	Submit the file online.
feedback	feedback / retorno	The professor gave detailed feedback.



VOCABULARY 02

Common academic actions

These combinations appear constantly in classes, projects, and communication with professors.

EXPRESSION	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USE
take a course	cursar uma disciplina	I am taking a programming course.
attend a lecture	assistir a uma aula	I could not attend the lecture.
take notes	fazer anotações	I take notes during class.
hand in an assignment	entregar um trabalho	We have to hand in the assignment tomorrow.
submit online	enviar online	The report must be submitted online.
meet a deadline	cumprir prazo	We need to meet the deadline.
study for an exam	estudar para prova	I am studying for an exam.
work in a group	trabalhar em grupo	We have to work in a group of four.
give a presentation	fazer uma apresentação	We are giving a presentation on Monday.
ask for clarification	pedir esclarecimento	I asked for clarification after class.
office hours	horário de atendimento	The professor has office hours on Tuesday.
extension	prorrogação	Can I request an extension?

Study tip

Learn complete expressions, not only isolated words. In conversation, retrieving a ready-made chunk is much faster than building every sentence from zero.



USEFUL PHRASES

What to say in real situations

These phrases are designed to be spoken. Read them aloud and imagine the exact situation where you would use each one.

SITUATION	PHRASE	USE / MEANING
Clarify task	Could you explain the assignment again?	Ask for clarification.
	What exactly do we need to submit?	Confirm deliverable.
	Is there a required format?	Confirm format.
Deadline	When is it due?	Ask deadline.
	Is the deadline at midnight?	Confirm exact time.
	Would it be possible to request an extension?	Ask politely for more time.
Classmates	Which part do you want to work on?	Divide tasks.
	Let us combine our notes.	Collaborate.
	Can we meet before class?	Schedule group work.
Professor	Could I ask you a quick question?	Start politely.
	I am not sure I understood this part.	Explain confusion.
	Could you give me some feedback on...?	Request feedback.

Make it yours

Choose three phrases from this page and rewrite them with details from your own life. Personal examples are easier to remember and use naturally.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

Have to, need to, and be supposed to

Use “have to” for requirements, “need to” for something necessary, and “be supposed to” for an expectation, rule, or agreed plan.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
have to	We have to submit the report by Friday.	requirement
need to	I need to finish my section tonight.	necessity
supposed to	We are supposed to work in groups of four.	expectation / rule
do not have to	You do not have to print the report.	not required
not supposed to	We are not supposed to use AI for this task.	rule against something

Assignment checklist

WHAT -> FORMAT -> DEADLINE -> SUBMISSION -> EVALUATION. Confirm these five points whenever a task is unclear.

Mini practice

Complete: We _____ to submit the file online.

Complete: I _____ to finish my part tonight.

Complete: We are _____ to present for ten minutes.

Write one sentence about something you do not have to do for a class.

MODEL DIALOGUE

Clarifying a group assignment

The student confirms the deliverable, deadline, group size, and presentation requirement instead of guessing.

STUDENT Professor, could I ask you a quick question about the project?

PROFESSOR Of course. What would you like to clarify?

STUDENT What exactly do we need to submit next Friday?

PROFESSOR You have to submit the written report and the presentation slides.

STUDENT Do we need to print the report?

PROFESSOR No, you do not have to print it. Submit both files online.

STUDENT Okay. Are we supposed to present on the same day?

PROFESSOR No. Presentations start the following Monday.

STUDENT And how long should the presentation be?

PROFESSOR About ten minutes, followed by five minutes for questions.

STUDENT Great. One last question: can we work in groups of five?

PROFESSOR The normal limit is four, but talk to me after class if you have a specific reason.

Clarification saves time

Repeating the assignment requirements in your own words is much easier than discovering a misunderstanding near the deadline.

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build useful sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson. More than one answer may be correct.

1. Eu estou cursando cinco disciplinas neste semestre.
2. O trabalho deve ser entregue na sexta-feira.
3. Nós temos que enviar o relatório online.
4. Eu preciso terminar a minha parte hoje.
5. Nós devemos trabalhar em grupos de quatro.
6. Não precisamos imprimir o relatório.
7. Quando é o prazo?
8. O que exatamente precisamos entregar?
9. Existe um formato obrigatório?
10. Posso pedir uma prorrogação?
11. Podemos nos encontrar antes da aula?
12. Eu não tenho certeza se entendi esta parte.

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write a clarification email-style message

Even if you send it through a learning platform, a short academic message should identify the course, the task, and the exact point you need clarified.

Task: Write 90-120 words to a professor about an assignment. Mention the course or project, explain what you already understand, ask two or three specific questions about deadline, format, submission, or presentation, and thank the professor.

Try to include some of these:

- I have a question about...
- As I understand it,...
- Could you confirm...?
- Do we have to...?
- Are we supposed to...?
- Is there a required...?
- When is...?
- Thank you for your help.

Simple structure

CONTEXT -> WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND -> SPECIFIC QUESTIONS -> THANKS. Avoid asking “Can you explain everything?” when you can identify the exact doubt.

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I identify the assignment clearly?
- ☐ Did I show what I already understand?
- ☐ Are my questions specific?
- ☐ Could the professor answer quickly without asking me what I mean?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and complete each situation before asking the AI to correct you. Try to stay in English even when you need time to think.

Role-play 1 · Ask the professor

The AI is your professor. Clarify an assignment: required format, deadline, group size, submission method, and presentation length.

Role-play 2 · Group project

The AI is a classmate. Divide the project into tasks, choose deadlines for each part, and schedule a meeting to combine the work.

Role-play 3 · Deadline problem

You may miss a deadline because of a real scheduling problem. Explain the situation politely, show what you have completed, and ask whether an extension is possible.

Questions to practise

- What exactly do we need to submit?
- When is it due?
- Is there a required format?
- Do we have to work in groups?
- Are we supposed to present?
- How long should the presentation be?
- Where do we submit it?
- Could I request an extension?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. The goal is to see what you can produce from memory, not only what you recognize on the page.

1. Translate: trabalho / atividade = _____
2. Translate: presença = _____
3. Translate: prorrogação = _____
4. Complete: We _____ to submit the report by Friday.
5. Complete: I _____ to finish my part tonight.
6. Complete: We are _____ to present for ten minutes.
7. Translate: “Não precisamos imprimir o relatório.”
8. Translate: “Qual é o prazo?”
9. Ask what exactly must be submitted.
10. Ask whether there is a required format.
11. Ask for clarification politely.
12. Ask to meet a classmate before class.
13. Name the five points in the assignment checklist.
14. Write one sentence with “not supposed to”.
15. Write one sentence with “feedback”.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The versions below are natural examples using the language taught in this lesson.

Grammar mini practice

- have
- need
- supposed
- Answers vary.

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. I am taking five courses this semester.
2. The assignment is due on Friday.
3. We have to submit the report online.
4. I need to finish my part today.
5. We are supposed to work in groups of four.
6. We do not have to print the report.
7. When is the deadline? / When is it due?
8. What exactly do we need to submit?
9. Is there a required format?
10. Can I request an extension?
11. Can we meet before class?
12. I am not sure I understood this part.

Review strategy

Mark the sentences that felt slow or uncertain. Say those sentences aloud three times, then create one new example with the same structure.

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real objective is to understand the topic and communicate without stopping every time you need a new sentence.

1. assignment
2. attendance
3. extension
4. have
5. need
6. supposed
7. We do not have to print the report.
8. When is the deadline? / When is it due?
9. What exactly do we need to submit?
10. Is there a required format?
11. Could you explain this part again?
12. Can we meet before class?
13. what, format, deadline, submission, evaluation
- 14-15. Answers vary.

READY FOR CONVERSATION?**If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.**

- ✓ Discuss classes, assignments, and deadlines.
- ✓ Use have to, need to, and be supposed to correctly.
- ✓ Ask for clarification from a professor.
- ✓ Organize responsibilities in a group project.

Next lesson suggestion: Phone Calls, Appointments & Scheduling